

Yahoo! Messenger 7.0

Of all the IM clients that are tied to a portal, Yahoo! integrates its features in the best manner possible. In the new version 7.0, it comes with the added feature of video calling. Yahoo's interface, though well laid out, still feels a bit clustered because there are too many buttons too close to each other.

The colour scheme, though, is what saves this chat engine from being unusable. Come to chatting and Yahoo! delivers one of the best chatting experiences. It has smileys to express almost any expression one would like to convey, and if you're not happy, you can add your own customised smileys here as well (like with MSN).



The chat window has standard font customisation with audibles, which express emotions with that extra bit of humour. One feature that really stands out for Yahoo! is the message archive and reading of offline messages. If you have something short and urgent to say, you can literally drop a line!

Though the program's animated emoticons and 'IMVironments' seems to appeal to younger users, they, quite surprisingly, turn out to be good for breaking the monotony. A great example of the integrated network supporting interesting extras is the Yahoo! Photos IMVironment, which lets you share photos you have stored online right in the messaging window.

Sadly, ads appear in the multi-user chat window, although